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EXERCISE BOOK

Name: Chukwika
Class: _____
Subject: Phil M.
Date: _____

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LEAVES

1. With only one clear point each, demonstrate how interactionism, epiphenomenalism, occasionalism and parallelism differ from one another within the discussion of psychosomatic unity.
2. Explain in detail Attributive Monism.
3. Briefly identify and clarify the factors that characterize mental activities.
4. Within the Framework of philosophy of mind, compare the Platonic Tripartite division of human soul and Aristotelian postulation of the soul as a capacity.

Idealism posits that the mental or spiritual realm is the foundation or substance of reality. Physical objects and the external world are either dependent on or derived from mental phenomena. For this, the external world is a manifestation of the mind or is shaped by mental activity.

Logical behaviorism
It argues that mental states are descriptions of observable behaviours or dispositions to behave in certain ways. It tries to find the meaning of mental states in observable phenomena.

Explain in detail Attributive monism.

MONISM.

Monism is the school of thought that holds that mind and body cannot be independent substances. It came as unsatisfactory and complex development of dualism.

Monism underscores that there is only one reality that exists. For them both mental and physical activities are different expressions of one and the same reality.

There are three various groups of monism which are: Attributive monism, Substance monism and Dual-Aspect monism. Our focus is on Attributive monism.

ATTRIBUTIVE MONISM.

Attributive monism upholds that there are many individual attributes that make up one single entity. It is classified into

1. Idealism.
2. Materialism
3. Neutral monism.

IDEALISM.

Idealism argues that only mental activities exist. Physical experiences are only inventions of the mind. Berkeley is a key proponent of idealism and rejects empirical position as well as reduces all sense perception to ideas.

Berkeley asserted that "to be is to be perceived". This for him means "to be is to be either a perceiver, a subject, a mind, (spirit) or an object of perception (an idea). Hence for him the question of mind-body interaction doesn't exist.

MATERIALISM.

Materialism also referred to as physicalism is opposed to idealism, since it gives primacy to the body, and contends that only physical substances exist. Democritus is a major example of a material monist.

It opines that the functioning of the brain accounts for mental activities hence man is nothing else but the body. Activities like consciousness, emotions are functional attributes of the body.

Materialism is grouped into two.

1. Reductive Materialism
2. Non-reductive materialism.

REDUCTIVE

This argues that mental events can be reduced to those of physical and be subjected to physical laws as well. There are three forms of reductive materialism.

1. Logical Behaviourism:- It argues that mental states are dispositions to behave; ~~identit~~ Gilbert Ryle is a proponent of this position and argues that Cartesian dualism is a myth and stigma of the ghost in the machine in his work 'The Concept of mind'.
2. Identity Theory:- It is a form of physicalism that reduces mental events to physical processes. It holds that mental states and events are ⁱⁿ distinguishable with those of physical (Brain) as both are aspects of one and the same thing. (for every mental state or process, there is a corresponding physical state or process in the brain.)
3. Functionalism:- This claims that mental states are functional states (input/output) of the individual and not with the substance. As such, an internal state is considered a mental one if it plays a relevant causal role

in relation to other physical processes.

NON-REDUCTIVE

Non-reductive materialism asserts that mental ^{events} ~~activities~~ cannot be reduced to those of physical even though the former supervenes on the latter. For them, mental ^{events} depend on physical ~~events~~ objects but they are not reducible to them. It is also categorized into ^{two} ~~three~~.

1. Anomalous Materialism: This clarifies that mental events are identical to physical ones by that they are anomalous, i.e. they ^{are} still under mental descriptions and are not regulated by strict physical laws. An outstanding figure here is David Davidson.

2. Eliminative Materialism: This claims that only empirically verifiable concepts with physical describable basis have meaning, it upholds the view that our common sense, beliefs and desires must be replaced by empirical sciences. As such they advocate for elimination of mental vocabularies arguing that they are often false, meaningless and nondescriptive of reality. Gilbert Ryle and language analyst belong to this group.

NEUTRAL MONISM.

Neutral monism teaches that both the physical and mental events are ontologically not different but they are two ways of describing one and the same neutral substance of human activities. Hence, both can be reduced to only one thing.

Dualism.

Demonstrate how interactionism, epiphenomenalism, occasionalism and parallelism differ from one another within the discussion of psychosomatic unity.

Dualism

Dualism is a philosophical system that acknowledges that there are two different entities co-existing and interacting in the same living person, the mind and the body. The dualists generally agree that the mind which is immaterial in nature is distinct and separable from the material body.

Forms of dualism include:

1. Substance dualism
2. Property
3. Predicate
4. Epistemological
5. Metaphysical
6. Ethical. (connects to Good and Evil)

Substance Dualism

This is synonymous with Cartesian dualism. It tenaciously holds that there are two different substances that co-exist in man - the mind and the body. Both are substantively different in that one is material and the other immaterial.

Property Dualism

This maintains the position that there is only but one fundamental substance which is physical. However, the physical substance has both physical and mental properties. They are of two groups...

Predicate Dualism.

This position argues that more than one predicate is required to make sense of our sensual and psychological experiences (mind and body activities). As such mental properties cannot be simply reduced to those of physical predicate.

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Predicate Dualism.

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Epistemological Dualism.

They are of the view that physical objects and

mental ideas are distinct. In other words, the world we see experience is not the real one but its representation. For them, there is a mental subjective world that represents aspects of an external objective world.

Metaphysical Dualism.

This differentiates between physical and non-physical exemplified in the God-world relationship.

MAJOR VARIETIES OF DUALISM.

INTERACTIONISM.

Interactionism is one of the varieties of Dualism which states that mental activities cause physical effects and physical activities cause mental effects. It's a two-way process.

It holds that the mind and body, though separate and distinct substances, causally interact. The mind is dependent on the body for its mental activities as well as the body dependent on the mind for its proper functioning. For example, "Being hungry" which is a mental activity, causes someone to eat, which is a physical activity. Also the injury on the ^{skin} body.

(body) causes pain (mind)

Critics of interactionism question the possibility of the influence of totally immaterial phenomena on that of material and vice-versa. Also, it said to violate the law of conservation of energy which maintains that the amount of energy on the cosmos is always constant and by implication can neither be created or destroyed.

EPHENOMENALISM.

This theory emerged as a reaction to interactionism. It argues that material events cause mental effects but mental events do not cause physical effects. For them the body influences the mind but the mind cannot influence the body. It is therefore a one-way process, since mental events are only but the invention of the material.

An instance of this is that of shadow and voice echo. Epiphenomenalism is often considered as an aspect of materialism. However, it raises questions about the evolutionary purpose of consciousness if it has no causal efficacy.

OCCASIONALISM.

Occasionalism posits that there is a pre-established harmony between the mind and the body, whereby God intervenes by moving the body on each occasion of the mind's desire. This theory was proposed by Nicholas Malebranche and Arnold Geulincx who wanted to solve the problem of interactionism as proposed by Descartes and their master.

According to them, each stance of the mind's and body desire creates an appropriate occasion of God's intervention. For example, a person desires to walk produce an occasion for God to bring about a motion. For

PARALLELISM.

Parallelism argues that the mind and body do not interact but instead run on parallel, pre-established tracks, like synchronized clocks. It rejects interactionism and epiphenomenalism and maintains that mental and physical events exist concomitantly as two parallel lines that have no connection and which never meet or interact in any course of action in man.

For them mental causes produce only mental effects,

and physical causes produce only physical effects.

However, it failed to explain the how of the succession or even the correlation between mental and bodily events since it denied their mutual, single causation as well as accidental relationship.

Factors and Functions of Mental Activities.

FACTORS.

1. Purposeful Behaviour.
2. Intentionality.
3. Consciousness / Subjective Experience.
4. Subjective Experience.

Purposeful Behaviour.

Purposeful Behaviour holds that mental activities are goal oriented behaviours. They are directed towards a goal purpose. It holds that mental activities are geared towards achieving a goal. Hence, mental activities and processes find fulfilment in the achievement of its goal.

Intentionality

Mental activities are characterized by their aboutness towards a particular subject. It refers to the fact that mental activities have an object (intentional object) which it represents and directed to. It also refers to the capacity to represent the object of the mind. There are two features of intentionality.

1. Psychological:- Here, concrete existence is irrelevant. In which case, truth as correspondence between what exist in the mind and in concrete is not applicable here. The existence of an object can only be in the mind.
2. Ontological (Referential opacity):- Only the object of intentionality is necessary here.

Consciousness / Subjective Experience.

Consciousness is a factor of mental activities; it refers to the immediate awareness of phenomenon. It is this consciousness that distinguishes the human mind from every other animal. There are two levels of consciousness:-

1. Awareness:-(Sensitive Consciousness):- It is the immediate knowledge of one's environment and surroundings. It also brings one closer to the existence of other things.
2. Self-Awareness (Reflective Consciousness):- This is the type of awareness which aids in the understanding of a thing in itself. It is intrinsic contemplation of the self.

FUNCTIONS.

1. Cognitive function:-

This is the intellectual capacity of the mind to acquire knowledge, understand the world, make decisions and solve problems, it is also responsible for how we think, learn, perceive, remember and respond to information.

2. Memorative function:-

Memory presupposes knowledge. It is the ability of the mind to code and store information in order to recall and represent them when needed. It is usually associated with the past but not exclusively. Forgetfulness and loss of memory are serious psychological sickness which affects memory.

3. Imaginative function:-

The competency of the mind to picture images of thought. These mental pictures can be existing or not as the mind can transcend all physical realms. This is why man is said to be physically limited but mindfully trespassing all boundaries. It makes inventions and changes possible.

4. Volitive Function:- This is the power of the mind to choose and decide. It is the capacity for intentional action and decision making. It involves setting goals, making choices and initiating actions based on one's desires and plans. It allows individuals to act in accordance with their intentions and values.

TYPES OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND IMPACT ON HUMAN LIFE -

Artificial Intelligence.

Types of Artificial Intelligence.

There are four types of Artificial intelligence.

1. Reactive Machines.
2. Limited Memory Machines.
3. Theory of Mind.
4. Self-Awareness.

REACTIVE MACHINES.

This is also understood as Artificial Narrow Intelligence (ANI). It automatically responds to stimuli according to given instructions. They are also extremely restricted in abilities and also due to their absence of memory, they have no capacity to learn.

These machines are basic AI systems, and thus do not store memories or use past experiences to determine future actions. They simply perceive the world and react to it as it has been directed to do.

LIMITED MEMORY MACHINES.

These machines in addition to what the reactive machine do, can learn, perceive, understand and perform man-like duties such as decision making.

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LIMITED MEMORY MACHINES.

These machines in addition to what the reactive machine do, can learn, perceive, understand and perform man-like duties such as decision making.

solving future problems and even improve their responses.

These Machines learn from the past and build experiential knowledge by observing actions and data. They can also detect fraud and conduct researches. It can be considered as Artificial General Intelligence. (AGI)

THEORY OF MINDS.

Since Cybernetic scientists constantly improve in their innovations, these group of machines are meant to understand other minds, grasp their beliefs, discern their needs and elicit emotions during communication.

It is made up of artificial intelligent and advanced systems that can perceive the concept of emotions and people and change their behaviour accordingly. It is also considered as (AGI) - Artificial General Intelligence.

SELF-AWARENESS.

It is also recognized as Artificial Super-Intelligence (ASI), whereby machines will be programmed to have human-like intelligence and consciousness (self-awareness).

In this hypothetical stage, machines will not just evoke or elicit emotions in man, but they will also experience

their own emotions, have needs to be attended to, as well as beliefs and desires of their own. This is exactly equating machines to human brain and function.

IMPLICATION ON HUMAN LIFE

ADVERSE.

1. Unemployment
2. Inequality
3. Dependency.
4. Human dignity.
5. Coping effect.

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